

**KRISTINA M. FULLERTON RICO**

(surname: Fullerton Rico)

Center for Racial Justice, Ford School of Public Policy  
University of MichiganEmail: fullertk [at] umich.edu  
www.fullertonrico.github.io**EDUCATION**


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|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Ph.D.</b> | <b>Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison</b><br><b>Dissertation:</b> Transnational Undocumented Aging: Challenges in Later Life<br><b>Preliminary Exams:</b> Ethnography, Gender | 2024 |
| <b>M.S.</b>  | <b>Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison</b><br><b>Thesis:</b> “Unos Allá, Otros Aquí.” Transnational Parenting and Digital Communication across the Mexico–U.S. Border          | 2019 |
| <b>B.A.</b>  | <b>Sociology, Reed College</b>                                                                                                                                                        | 2011 |

**ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS**


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| 2024– | <b>University of Michigan</b> Postdoctoral Fellowship, Center for Racial Justice, Ford School of Public Policy |
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**RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS**


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Migration, Race/Ethnicity, Indigeneity, Latine Studies, Aging, Gender, Family, Qualitative Methods

**PUBLICATIONS**


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Fullerton Rico, Kristina. 2025. [“Grieving in the ‘Golden Cage’: How Unauthorized Immigrants Contend with Death and Mourn from Afar.”](#) *Social Problems*.

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M. 2025. “Book Review: *When Care is Conditional: Immigrants and the U.S. Safety Net* by Dani Carrillo.” *Gender & Society*.

**IN PREPARATION**


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Fullerton Rico, Kristina M. *Caged In or Locked Out: How Immigration Policy Puts Undocumented Immigrants and their Families in a Double-Bind* (Book proposal and manuscript.)

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M. “International Immobility Across the Life Course.” (Article manuscript.)

Fullerton Rico, Kristina M., Aransa Hidaly Sanchez, Laura Enriquez. “(Im)mobility and Mourning in Mixed-Status Families.” (Article manuscript.)

## AWARDS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

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|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026      | Junior Scholars Symposium, Latinx Research Center, University of California, Berkeley                                                         |
| 2023–2024 | Predoctoral Fellowship, Center for Racial Justice, Ford School of Public Policy, University of Michigan (Funded)                              |
| 2022      | Dissertation Research Grant, Russell Sage Foundation (Funded)                                                                                 |
| 2021–2023 | Migration Fellow, Penn-Birmingham Transatlantic Migration Fellowship                                                                          |
| 2021–2022 | Advanced Opportunity Fellowship, UW–Madison (Funded)                                                                                          |
| 2021      | Honorable Mention Award, Esther Ngan-ling Chow and Maryjoyce Green Dissertation Scholarship, Sociologists for Women in Society (SWS) (Funded) |
| 2019–2021 | Graduate Research Fellowship, Institute for Research on Poverty, UW–Madison (Funded)                                                          |
| 2016–2017 | Advanced Opportunity Fellowship, UW-Madison (Funded)                                                                                          |

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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### *How Undocumented Immigrants Contend with International Immobility across the Life Course*

2026 ASA Annual Meeting, Regular Session (International Migration Section)

### *(Im)mobility and Mourning in Mixed-Status Families*

2025 ASA Annual Meeting, Regular Session (Latinas, Latinos, Latinx Section)

### *How U.S. Immigration Policies Drive Out Undocumented Grandparents and Restructure Mixed-Status Families.*

2025 ASA Annual Meeting, Roundtable (Section on Aging and the Life Course)

### *Retirement or Exile?: Return Migration Due to Undocumented Status in Later Life*

2024 ASA Annual Meeting, Regular Session (Section on Aging and the Life Course)

### *“The Price We Pay”: How Unauthorized Immigrants Endure Transnational Grief*

2022 ASA Annual Meeting, Regular Session (International Migration Section): Immigration and Implications for Mental Health.

2022 Chicago Ethnography Conference, Migration Panel.

2022 Boston Migration Workshop Work-in-Progress Workshop.

2021 ASA Annual Meeting, Roundtable (Global and Transnational Sociology Section)

2021 Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Session on Emotions and Emotion Management.

### *Using Interviews to Address Unequal Power Dynamics and Increase Transparency in Fieldwork*

2021 Sociologists for Women in Society Winter Meeting, Roundtable on Positionality, Research & Qualitative Methods.

### *Aquí y Allá: Transnational Parenting, Digital Siblinghood, and Communication Technologies*

2019 Sociologists for Women in Society Summer Meeting, Roundtable on Gender, Migration, and Identity.

2019 Chicago Ethnography Conference

2018 Chicago Ethnography Conference

## TEACHING POSITIONS

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### **University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy**

- 2026      Latine Social Movements and Policy Impacts (advanced undergraduate writing course)  
2025      U.S. Immigration Policy (sole instructor, graduate seminar)  
2024      U.S. Immigration Policy (sole instructor, graduate seminar)  
2023      Latine Social Movements in the U.S. (sole instructor, undergraduate and graduate seminar)

### **University of Michigan, Department of Sociology**

- 2024      Transnational Families (sole instructor, introductory undergraduate course)

### **University of Wisconsin-Madison, Chicanx/e and Latinx/e Studies Program**

- 2019–2020      Introduction to Chicanx/e and Latinx/e Studies (sole instructor, introductory undergraduate course)

### **University of Wisconsin-Madison, Department of Sociology**

- 2019      Population Problems (teaching assistant, introductory undergraduate course)  
2017–2018      Sociology of Gender (teaching assistant, introductory undergraduate course)

## RESEARCH POSITIONS

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- 2020      UW–Madison, Sociology Department  
Research Assistant to Prof. Jenna Nobles  
*Oversaw a research team of six students to transcribe, digitize, and code archival Mexico–U.S. migration data*

## INVITED TALKS AND GUEST LECTURES

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### **University of Michigan, Office of Academic Multicultural Initiatives**

- 2026      Keynote Speaker, La Celebración Latina Graduation Ceremony

### **University of Chicago, Crown Family School of Social Work, Policy, and Practice**

- 2025      Immigration, Law, and Society (undergraduate course)  
“Grieving in the Golden Cage: How Immigration Status Impacts Mourning.”

### **University of California, Irvine, Chicano/Latino Studies and Sociology Departments**

- 2024      Roundtable Q&A with graduate students

### **University of Wisconsin–Madison, Sociology Department**

- 2021      Ethnic Social Movements in the United States (undergraduate course)  
2021      Marriage and the Family (undergraduate course)

## SERVICE

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### **Reviewer**

*Gender & Society, International Migration Journal, Social Forces*

## Conference Planning

22nd Annual Chicago Ethnography Conference Organizing Committee Member 2019–2022  
(postponed due to COVID-19 pandemic)

## University of Michigan

Rackham Graduate School, Summer Research Opportunities Program Research Mentor 2025  
Rackham Graduate School, Aspiring Fellows Program Research Mentor 2024–2025

## University of Wisconsin-Madison

Qualitative Methods Workshop Discussant, Sociology Department 2022–2023  
Website Committee, Sociology Department 2020–2022  
Co-chair, Solidarity (Group for Graduate Students of Color) 2017  
Graduate Student Peer Mentor, Sociology 2017–2020  
Mentor to Undergraduate Students, PASOS, Chicanx/e and Latinx/e Studies 2016–2018  
Co-organizer, Teaching Race Workshop 2016–2017

## PUBLIC SOCIOLOGY (SELECTED OP-EDS, NEWS ARTICLES, MEDIA APPEARANCES)

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Fullerton Rico, Kristina. 2025. “Deportation fears create ripple effects for immigrants and their communities.” *The Conversation*. 19 February.  
<https://theconversation.com/deportation-fears-create-ripple-effects-for-immigrants-and-their-communities-248817>

Langfellow, Tony. 2021. “Breaking language barriers for COVID-19 vaccine info.” CBS affiliate, WSAW–TV. August 13.  
<https://www.wsaw.com/2021/08/13/breaking-language-barriers-covid-19-vaccine-info/>

Grieve Leave Podcast. 2026. “The Hidden Grief Costs of Immigration Policy with Dr. Kristina Fullerton Rico.” January 22.  
<https://www.grieveleave.com/podcast-episodes/the-hidden-grief-costs-of-immigration-policy-with-dr-kristina-fullerton-rico#>

Sun, Alice. 2024. “Easing the Toll of Long-Distance Grief.” *Yes! Magazine*, April 30.  
<https://www.yesmagazine.org/health-happiness/2024/04/30/death-distance-grief-immigration>

Sun, Alice. Translated by Kristina Fullerton Rico. 2024. “Cómo Apoyar a Las Personas Que Enfrentan el Duelo a Larga Distancia.” *Yes! Magazine*, October 23.  
<https://www.yesmagazine.org/health-happiness/2024/10/23/apoyar-duelo-distancia-larga>

## SKILLS

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**Languages:** English (fluent), Spanish (native speaker) **Software:** HyperResearch, MAXQDA, NVivo